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SOCIAL ILL FOUND IN ANTI-SEMITISM

Threat to Life of America Seen
by Proskauer as Jewish
Leaders Meet Here

An "international bill of rights" for the individual as well as the State, in which the "narrowing forces of supernationalism and chauvinism" would give way to the demands of justice and reason, was advocated yesterday in a program for solution of post-war Jewish problems by former Supreme Court Justice Joseph M. Proskauer.

Mr. Proskauer addressed 200 Jewish leaders assembled from all parts of the country at the thirty-seventh annual meeting of the American Jewish Committee in the Hotel Waldorf-Astoria, following his re-election as president of the committee.

He called also for relief for Jews suffering as a result of the "havoc and ruin of Axis barbarism," for international supervision of emigration when this was found necessary, and for development of Palestine as an economic, religious and cultural center for Jews who desired to live there.

As to Palestine, Mr. Proskauer declared that while the committee had urged Great Britain to abolish the White Paper of 1939 discriminating against immigration of Jews, Palestine must not be considered "the exclusive or the complete solution for the Jews of Europe." He added that "no matter what the political constitution of Palestine should be, there could be no political identification of Jews outside of Palestine with whatever government may be there instituted."

International Trusteeship

The committee itself recommended for Palestine "an international trusteeship responsible to the United Nations" which would "safeguard Jewish settlement and immigration and guarantee adequate scope for future growth and development to the full extent of the absorptive capacity of the country." It further urged "establishment within a reasonable period of a self-governing commonwealth under a constitution and a bill of rights that will safeguard and protect the fundamental rights of all inhabitants and the holy places of all faiths."

Mr. Proskauer asserted that anti-Semitism was a "social cancer" baneful to us Jews, but equally fatal, if unhealed, to the life of America itself. He warned Jews against "taking counsel of our fears" despite the growth of "venal organized manifestations of anti-Semitism which seek either sordid money or sordid political power," and urged a policy of "decency and brotherhood, and not divisiveness and hostility."

"We must guard ourselves," he declared, "against letting the mouthings of the bigot deafen us to the great mass of Christian understanding and kindness which permeates the country. Great noble utterances have come from men like Archbishop Spellman and Bishop Molloy, Catholic bishops of New York and Brooklyn, and Bishop Tucker, president of the Federal Council of Churches of Christ in America, as well as from scores of ministers of every faith. We believe and have the right to believe that America will ever remain the land of the free."

Group Suspicions

Jacob Blaustein, chairman of the executive committee, asserted that "Nazi propaganda techniques have succeeded to no inconsiderable extent in creating and increasing group hatreds and suspicions between various sections and fragments of the population of the United States." Alan M. Stroock, head of the administrative committee, said the problem was "not yet out of control."

"We still have both the opportunity and the challenge to deal effectively with this pernicious agitation," he commented. "As long as the great majority of Americans realize that anti-Semitism is not only a Jewish problem but an American problem, the challenge of benighted bigots and political charlatans can be met successfully."

George Z. Medalie, chairman of the overseas committee, declared that the "international bill of rights of man" should be "implemented by appropriate machinery protecting the individual against the invasion of his rights by reason of race or religion."